

Hanoi & Cat Ba Packing List

Fri 9 Oct to Sun 25 Oct 2026 | Singapore layover, Hanoi, Cat Ba Island (climbing + deep water soloing), Hanoi again

BAG

Backpack only. Aim for carry-on size and weight (check your airlines' limit, often about 7 kg).

WEATHER

About 22 - 30°C, humid, storms possible. Estimate, check nearer the date.

LAUNDRY

Plan to wash on the way (hotel or laundry shop), so pack for about 5 days.

Documents & money

- ☐ Passport (check expiry)
- ☐ E-visa approved, with a saved or printed copy
- ☐ Copies / scans of ID
- ☐ Insurance policy details
- ☐ Bookings saved offline (stays, transfer, DWS trips, flights)
- ☐ Bank cards (bank told you're travelling)
- ☐ Some Vietnamese dong in cash (Cat Ba transfer on the 12th is pay on arrival)

Bag

- ☐ Backpack (your only bag)
- ☐ Dry bag or waterproof phone pouch for boat and DWS days
- ☐ Packable daypack or stuff sack for Cat Ba days

Wear the bulkiest items (shoes, hoodie) on the plane.

Climbing

- ☐ Climbing shoes (clip outside or wear on the plane)
- ☐ Chalk bag and chalk, sealed
- ☐ Finger tape and skin balm
- ☐ Swimmers (1 - 2)
- ☐ Quick-dry towel

Harness, helmet and rope: check what Cat Ba Climbing and the DWS operators supply before you carry your own.

Clothes

- ☐ Zip pants, 2 (one to climb in, one for travel)
- ☐ Shorts, 2
- ☐ Quick-dry t-shirts / tops, 5
- ☐ Long-sleeve sun shirt, 1
- ☐ Light hoodie or jumper, 1 (planes, lounge, cooler nights)
- ☐ Underwear and socks, 5 - 6 each
- ☐ Lightweight packable rain jacket
- ☐ Sleepwear / light trackies
- ☐ Comfortable walking shoes + sandals or thongs
- ☐ Hat, sunglasses
- ☐ 1 slightly nicer outfit for Hanoi with your partner from the 22nd

No coat needed.

Toiletries

- ☐ Toothbrush and toothpaste
- ☐ Deodorant
- ☐ Reef-safe sunscreen (Lan Ha Bay)
- ☐ Insect repellent
- ☐ Vegan soap / shampoo, travel size
- ☐ Regular meds, small first aid kit, blister plasters
- ☐ Motion-sickness tablets (boat and transfers)

Liquids over 100 ml can't go in a carry-on bag, so decant into small bottles in a clear bag.

Electronics

- ☐ Phone and other chargers
- ☐ Plug adaptor (Vietnam is 220 V, Australian plugs won't fit) and power-board
- ☐ Headphones
- ☐ Battery pack (carry-on only, never checked)
- ☐ Novels downloaded
- ☐ Grab set up, Google Maps offline for Hanoi and Cat Ba

Flights & layover

- ☐ Vegan snacks
- ☐ Eye mask, earplugs, neck pillow (3:30am check-in, 6am flight)
- ☐ Empty water bottle to refill after security

Organising

- ☐ **Phone / data:** sort an eSIM for Vietnam (check your phone supports eSIM). The Singapore layover needs wifi or data too.
- ☐ **Bank:** tell them you're going overseas (probably possible in the app). Check the card works abroad and the foreign fees.
- ☐ **ID copies:** scans saved offline and emailed to yourself.
- ☐ **Insurance:** the tracker task is still open. World Nomads excludes deep water soloing on every plan, so buy a main policy for the rest and ask the DWS operator for their cover terms in writing.
- ☐ **E-visa:** confirm it's approved before flying.
- ☐ **Home:** turn off home routines before leaving (tracker task).
- ☐ **Not booked yet:** Hanoi stay for 20 - 25 Oct, and the Melbourne flight on 25 Oct.

Travelling around

- ☐ **Fri 9 Oct, to the airport:** uber? Confirm the time.
- ☐ **Fri 9 - Sat 10, Singapore:** lounge booked (about 5 hrs). Be at check-in / security about 3:30am for the 6am Hanoi flight. Free Changi City Sights tour or Jewel to fill the evening.
- ☐ **Sat 10, Hanoi airport to Urban Fragrance (Old Quarter):** Grab or a pre-booked transfer. The 86 bus is the cheap option, check before relying on it.
- ☐ **Mon 12, Hanoi to Cat Ba:** transfer confirmed, pay on arrival. The 07:30 departure gets you climbing that afternoon. Free hotel pickup is usually Old Quarter only.
- ☐ **Cat Ba, 12 - 20:** Bao Phuc Hotel (143 Tung Dinh) is about a 5 min walk to the centre; Cat Ba Climbing meets at 120 Nui Ngoc. DWS days: Wed 14 and Mon 19.
- ☐ **Tue 20, Cat Ba back to Hanoi:** return transport not yet booked.
- ☐ **Sun 25, Hanoi airport to Melbourne:** flight not yet booked; Grab to the airport.

Draft built from the itinerary and notes in the tracker plus general Hanoi / Cat Ba knowledge. Weather and quantities are estimates; adjust to suit you.